

DESPERATE MEASURES

Desperate Measures is a narrative mechanic that captures those heart-pounding, cinematic moments where a hero is battered, bleeding, and pushed to the absolute brink, yet refuses to fall. It represents the player burning away their own future for one spectacular, heroic surge of adrenaline.

GRIM BARGAIN

On your turn, if a character is bloodied (at half or fewer hit points) they can pre-mark a certain number of death save throw failures in exchange for specified consequences. The death saves reset after a long rest.

FOR 1 DEATH SAVE: (CHOOSE ONE)

- Immediately take the dash and disengage as extra actions
- give yourself a +5 bonus to any d20 test you just failed
- re-roll a failed d20 attack roll

FOR 2 DEATH SAVES:

- if an attack roll hits, each damage die deals maximum damage

FOR 3 DEATH SAVES: (CHOOSE ONE)

- you can immediately take the Attack or Magic action as an extra action
- you immediately regain an extended spell slot of Level 1 through 5

MARTYR'S SPARK

Additionally, while you are at 0 hit points and making death saving throws, and a creature fails a d20 test, you can convert one of your current successful death saving throws into a failure, and that creature can reroll the failed d20 test. The creature must use the new roll.

